

Parasocial relationships and sponsors- sponsee congruence in E-sports sponsorship effectiveness across endemic and non-endemic sponsors

Theo NOYON

KEDGE Business School

1 September 2026

Bordeaux

This report is submitted in partial fulfilment of the Business Research
Skills and Methods course at KEDGE Business School.

Word count: **2455** words excluding appendix etc

1 STATEMENT OF ORIGINALITY AND ETHICAL CONDUCT

I hereby declare that this report, titled "Parasocial relationships and sponsor-sponsee congruence in E-sports sponsorship effectiveness across endemic and non-endemic sponsors", submitted as partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of Master in Management at the KEDGE Business School, is my original work and has not been submitted previously for a degree or diploma at any other educational institution.

I confirm that:

1. I have fully acknowledged and referenced all sources of information and data used in the preparation of this thesis using APA 6th level standard.
2. All verbatim extracts have been distinguished by quotation marks and the sources of information specifically cited (with a name and year of publication).
3. No material other than that referenced and acknowledged has been used in the preparation of this thesis.
4. The work and research presented in this report have been carried out in accordance with the academic and ethical standards of KEDGE Business School.
5. I am aware of the rules on the use of generative Artificial Intelligence (AI) on this course.
6. Any use of generative AI tools (such as Chat GPT, Copilot, etc.) must be declared upfront, with all prompts and outputs included in the appendix of your reports and correctly cited.
7. A self-assessment of similarity of Safe assign is **1%**. (Include a screenshot in the appendix).
8. A self-assessment of AI generated text is **0%**. (Include a screenshot in the appendix).

I am aware of the consequences of breaching academic integrity policies of the KEDGE Business School, including the potential disqualification from the degree program.

Signed,

2 EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Sponsorship money keeps going into e-sports. The evidence on what makes it work has not really followed. Three audience mechanism come up again and again in the literature: attachment to a player or a streamer, the perceived fit between a sponsor and the entity it backs and whether the sponsor comes from gaming or somewhere else. Each of them has reasonable support on its own and that is part of the issue because they have almost always been studied on their own. This report asks how parasocial relationships and sponsor-sponsee congruence work together on perceived sponsorship effectiveness and whether the answer changes depending on the type of sponsor.

A self-completion online questionnaire was built for that, using items adapted from scales that have already been validated, and it was then tested on ten respondents recruited through e-sport communities (discord, reddit...) Ten responses obviously cannot test a relationship between variables. The pilot was therefore treated from the start as an instrument validation exercise, whether the items are read the way they were meant to be read, whether the answer vary enough to be worth anything, how long the questionnaire takes and whether recruitment would hold up at a bigger scale.

Three problems came out of it and all three would have caused damage later. Respondents did not classify sponsors as endemic or non-endemic in a consistent way. The same brand ended up in opposite categories depending on who was answering which means that variable must be coded by the researcher and not left to the respondent. The two reverse worded attention checks also produced answer that went against the rest of their own block, so they need to be rewritten or dropped. The effectiveness items came out with a clear floor effect and are probably not sensitive enough. Recruitment and completion time were fine. None on these answers the research question but it does say what needs to change first, and the recommendation is a revised instrument with quota-based sampling for the full study.

3 ABBREVIATIONS LIST

Abbreviation	Meaning
CS2	Counterstrike 2
GDPR	General Data Protection Regulation
LEC	League of Legends EMEA Championship
LoL	League of Legends
PSI	Parasocial interaction
PSR	Parasocial relationship
SD	Standard deviation
SEM	Structural equation modelling

4 GLOSSARY

Term	Definition
Congruence	The perceived fit between a sponsor and the entity it sponsors.
Convenience sampling	A non-probability sampling technique in which participants are selected on the basis of accessibility to the researcher.
E-sports	Competitive video gaming in which professional players or teams compete in tournaments.
Endemic sponsor	A sponsor whose core business is native to the gaming industry, such as Razer.
Non-endemic sponsor	A sponsor from a different sector than gaming, such as Kit-Kat.
Floor effect	A pattern in which responses cluster at the lowest point of a measurement scale, limiting its ability to discriminate.
Likert scale	An ordered response format on which respondents indicate their level of agreement with a statement.
Parasocial relationship	A one-sided attachment formed by an audience member towards a media figure who does not reciprocate it.
Pilot study	The pre-testing of a research instrument to establish whether it functions as intended before a full-scale study
Reverses-coded item	A negatively worded item included to detect inattentive or acquiescent responding.
Sponsor-sponsee	The two parties to a sponsorship relationship, the paying sponsor and the sponsored entity.

5 TABLE OF CONTENTS

1	STATEMENT OF ORIGINALITY AND ETHICAL CONDUCT	1
2	EXECUTIVE SUMMARY	2
3	ABBREVIATIONS LIST	3
4	GLOSSARY	4
5	TABLE OF CONTENTS	5
6	INTRODUCTION	7
6.1	BACKGROUND TO THE STUDY	7
6.2	RESEARCH SIGNIFICANCE.....	7
6.3	THE RESEARCH PROBLEM.....	7
6.4	SCOPE OF THIS RESEARCH	8
6.5	RESEARCH AIM AND OBJECTIVES	8
7	LITERATURE REVIEW	9
7.1	KEY THEMES AND THEIR CRITICAL APPRAISAL.....	9
7.2	RESEARCH GAP	10
7.3	SUMMARY TABLE OF LITERATURE.....	11
8	METHOD.....	13
8.1	DATA USE JUSTIFICATION.....	13
8.2	RESEARCH TOOL AND QUESTIONS DESIGN JUSTIFICATION.....	13
8.3	RESEARCH STRATEGY JUSTIFICATION	14
8.4	ETHICAL CONSIDERATIONS	14
9	PLAN AND TIMELINE OF KEY RESEARCH MILESTONES	15
10	DATA ANALYSIS AND DISCUSSION	17
10.1	SAMPLE AND DATA CLEANSING.....	17
10.2	ITEM CLARITY AND INSTRUMENT VALIDITY	19
10.3	RESPONSE VARIANCE	19
10.4	COMPLETION TIME AND RECRUITMENT FEASIBILITY	19
10.5	DISCUSSION	20
11	CONCLUSIONS	22
11.1	PRELIMINARY ANSWERS TO THE RESEARCH QUESTION	22
11.2	LIMITATIONS OF THIS WORK	22

11.3	RECOMMENDATIONS FOR FUTURE RESEARCH	22
11.4	RECOMMENDATIONS FOR PRACTICE.....	22
12	REFERENCES	23
13	APPENDIX A: FULL TRANSCRIPTION OF THE GOOGLE FORMS (FR/EN)	26
13.1	FORM TITLE:	26
13.2	FORM DESCRIPTION:.....	26
13.3	BLOCK 0 - CONSENT AND SCREENING	27
13.4	BLOCK 1 - REFERENCE SPONSOR.....	27
13.5	BLOCK 2 - PARASOCIAL RELATIONSHIP (PSR)	28
13.6	BLOCK 3 - PERCEIVED SPONSOR-SPONSEE CONGRUENCE	29
13.7	BLOCK 4 - PERCEIVED SPONSORSHIP EFFECTIVENESS	30
13.8	BLOCK 5 - INSTRUMENT FEEDBACK	31
13.9	END-OF-FORM CONFIRMATION MESSAGE	31
14	APPENDIX B: CONSENT DOCUMENTATION	32
14.1	CONSENT AS PRESENTED TO PILOT RESPONDENTS	32
14.2	RECRUITMENT MESSAGE	32
15	APPENDIX C: DATA COLLECTION QUESTIONS JUSTIFICATION TABLE.....	33
16	APPENDIX D: ANONYMISED PILOT RESPONSE DATA	35
17	APPENDIX E: AI PROMPTS (RESEARCH & ANALYSIS ASSISTANCE, TABLE FORMATTING & APA CITATION FORMATTING).....	36
18	APPENDIX F: SELF ASSESMENT	41
18.1	SAFE ASSIGN – LEARN KEDGE BUSINESS SCHOOL	41
18.2	COMPILATIO TOOL.....	41

6 INTRODUCTION

E-sports sponsorship has grown very fast as a commercial category. The evidence on why it works or does not work grown at the same speed (Freitas et al., 2020). As e-sports has found a place in sport management research (Funk et al., 2018), two audience-facing mechanisms have come forward as the main explanations: the parasocial relationship between viewers and the players or streamers they follow and perceived sponsor-sponsee congruence. Both have been studied, rarely at the same time.

6.1 Background to the study

E-sports sponsorship separates endemic sponsors whose core business belongs to gaming from non-endemic sponsors coming from other sectors (Gawrysiak et al., 2020). The LEC carries both, from Razer to Kit Kat. That distinction is close to what Gwinner (1997) called image transfer in event sponsorship where the fit between sponsor and sponsee shapes the reaction of the audience. Rogers et al. (2020) find the same thing empirically, since audience response shifts with how close a sponsor sits to gaming culture.

6.2 Research significance

Sponsorship is one of the main revenue streams for e-sports organizations, so choosing which brands to sign has direct commercial consequences. Practitioners still have very little evidence on whether the mechanisms used to justify those investments reinforce each other or just run side by side and whether they behave the same way for endemic and non-endemic brands. That matters for sponsors considering market entry, for organisations pricing their inventory, and for a field that has kept three related mechanisms in separate boxes.

6.3 The research problem

Parasocial relationships shape brand attitude through streamer credibility (Xu et al., 2022). Congruence has been linked to brand equity and purchase behavior (Noh et al., 2025; Wu et al., 2025), a distinction that has been modelled conceptually but never really tested (Gawrysiak et al., 2020). Hence the central question: how do parasocial relationships and sponsor-sponsee

congruence jointly influence e-sports sponsorship effectiveness, and does that influence differ between endemic and non-endemic sponsors?

6.4 Scope of this research

The study looks at perceived sponsorship effectiveness across its cognitive, affective and conative dimension among adult viewers who follow e-sports competitions or streamers. Organisational and financial outcomes are out of scope. This report only covers the pilot stage, which means designing and testing a questionnaire rather than answering the research question.

6.5 Research aim and objectives

The research aims to examine how parasocial relationships and sponsor-sponsee congruence jointly influence perceived e-sports sponsorship effectiveness and whether this differs between endemic and non-endemic sponsors. Three objectives apply at the pilot stage:

1. To design and pilot-test a questionnaire measuring parasocial relationship strength, perceived sponsor-sponsee congruence and perceived sponsorship effectiveness, using ten responses collected during August 2026.
2. To assess the clarity, completion time and response variance of each item and identify the ones that need revision before a full-scale study.
3. To evaluate whether e-sports viewers can realistically be recruited online and whether named sponsors can be classified as endemic or non-endemic, so as to inform the sampling strategy of the main study.

7 LITERATURE REVIEW

7.1 Key themes and their critical appraisal

The work on parasocial relationships in e-sports keeps running into the same gap, a lot on audience attachment, much less on what that attachment does commercially. Studies of Twitch viewing motivation document strong social and community engagement (Hilvert-Bruce et al., 2018; Sjöblom & Hamari, 2017) and extend the older accounts of parasocial interaction (Giles, 2002; Horton & Wohl, 1956), but they stop before sponsorship outcomes. Wohn et al. (2018) get closer by correlating parasocial relationships with the emotional, instrumental and financial support viewers give streamers. Support given to a streamer is still not support given to a sponsor. Only Xu et al. (2022) really close the distance, showing that streamer credibility predicts brand attitude through parasocial relationship and loyalty rather than directly, and a lot of weight ends up resting on that one study.

Congruence follows a similar pattern, with independent support that is not particularly consistent. It builds on image transfer in event sponsorship (Gwinner, 1997; Speed & Thompson, 2000). Noh et al. (2025) found e-sports consumption had no direct effect on brand equity, with congruence fully or partially mediating it, which makes congruence look like a necessary condition rather than an additive one. Wu et al. (2025) model perceived fit next to awareness and attitude as parallel predictors of purchase behavior, which implies something more distributed, and Polyakova et al. (2024) place fit as mediator between involvement and purchase intention. Liu and Liu (2025) note that e-sports is still under-examined as a setting for congruence research.

Sponsor type is the third strand and the one where the disagreement is most open. Rogers et al. (2020) manipulated sponsor type experimentally and found audiences responded best when the sponsor lined up closely with the gaming industry. Calapez et al. (2024) report something similar, with fans favouring endemic sponsors. Huettermann et al. (2020) arrive at a different conclusion, showing that non-endemic sponsors can generate positive attitudes and purchase intentions independently their relationship with the sponsee. This contradiction could originate from differences in methodology. Experimental setting that places sponsors side by side encourage respondents that participants have already encountered. Endemicity may therefore be less an inherent characteristic of the brand than a perception shaped by the comparative context created

by the research design. The evolutionary model of brand entry from Gawrysiak et al. (2020) would help settle this, but it is still conceptual.

One caution applies to all three strands. Most of the evidence comes from self-report designs and effect sizes shrink when the stimuli are less realistic (Kim et al., 2015). That applies to the present study too.

7.2 Research gap

Parasocial relationships are evidenced through streamer credibility and brand attitude (Xu et al., 2022), congruence through brand equity and purchase behavior (Noh et al., 2025). Endemic status shapes audience response (Rogers et al., 2020) although the contrary finding from Huettermann et al. (2020) shows the distinction is neither settled nor independent of how it gets measured. No study places sponsor type next to either mechanism as a moderator and none tests whether the two mechanisms work jointly. So, the gap is not only missing research. It is an open disagreement that a joint design could help arbitrate.

7.3 Summary table of literature

Table 1: Summary of literature reviewed

Author(s) & Year	Theme	Method & Context	Key finding	Use in this report
Calapez et al. (2024)	Fan identity and sponsor-sponsee relationship	Survey (N = 356), SEM	Fan role-identity shapes sponsor attitude and purchase intention	Supports endemic preference alongside Rogers et al. (2020)
Freitas et al. (2020)	E-sports sponsorship risks and tactics	Integrative literature review	Identifies reputational and industry-stability risks alongside benefits	Establishes practical significance of e-sports sponsorship
Funk et al. (2018)	E-sport as a sport management object	Conceptual	Argues for e-sports legitimacy as a scholarly subject	Establishes scholarly legitimacy of the research context
Gawrysiak et al. (2020)	Endemic / non-endemic brand evolution	Conceptual literature review	Proposes an evolutionary model of brand entry into e-sports	Shows the endemic distinction remains untested; defines endemic status
Giles (2002)	Parasocial interaction - review and model	Literature review, model-building	Extends parasocial relationships beyond Horton and Wohl (1956)	Theoretical extension of parasocial interaction
Gwinner (1997)	Image transfer in event sponsorship	Conceptual model	Image transfer strengthened by sponsor-event fit	Theoretical foundation for congruence; justifies Block 3 items
Hilvert-Bruce et al. (2018)	Live-stream social engagement	Survey (N = 2,227)	Social interaction and community drive viewer engagement	Documents engagement without sponsorship outcomes
Horton and Wohl (1956)	Parasocial interaction - foundational theory	Conceptual	Introducing parasocial interaction as one-sided attachment	Foundational concept; justifies item Q2.2
Huettermann et al. (2020)	Non-endemic sponsorship perceptions	Survey, adapted sponsorship model	Non-endemic sponsors can generate favorable attitudes and purchase intentions	Counterweight to Rogers et al. (2020); grounds the research gap
Jo et al. (2026)	Consumer beliefs about e-sports sponsorship	Scale development and validation	Provides a validated instrument for e-sports sponsorship beliefs	Recommended alternative to adapted effectiveness items
Kim et al. (2015)	Sponsorship effectiveness	Meta-analysis	Effect sizes shrink under less realistic conditions	Methodological caution; justifies Block 4 dimensions
Liu and Liu (2025)	Sports event-brand fit	Meta-analysis, 31 studies, N = 15,744	Fit affects cognitive, emotional and behavioral responses	Direct support for the research gap
Noh et al. (2025)	Congruence as mediator	Survey (N = 1,353)	Congruence mediates consumption to brand-equity link	Congruence as necessary condition; Block 3 operationalization
Polyakova et al. (2024)	Involvement, fit, purchase intention	Survey, e-sports tournament viewers	Perceived fit mediates involvement and purchase intention	Arbitrates Noh et al. and Wu et al.; justifies item Q4.2

Author(s) & Year	Theme	Method & Context	Key finding	Use in this report
Rogers et al. (2020)	Endemic vs non-endemic sponsors	Four-condition experiment	Endemicity and credibility drive favorable response	Establishes sponsor type mechanism; qualified in Chapter 5
Rubin et al. (1985)	Parasocial interaction measurement	Survey (N = 329), scale validation	Develops and validates the parasocial interaction scale	Origin of the Block 2 measurement scale
Saunders et al. (2019)	Business research methods	Textbook	Research onion, sampling, questionnaire design, ethics	Methodological foundation across Chapter 3
Sherrick et al. (2023)	Parasocial phenomena and community	Empirical, Twitch	Parasocial phenomena contribute to sense of community	Extends PSR beyond the individual streamer relationship
Silva and Almeida (2024)	Brand authenticity and brand equity	Survey, Brazilian LoL championship, SEM	Authenticity affects brand equity; gamer experience moderates	Precedent for moderation testing in e-sports sponsorship
Sjöblom and Hamari (2017)	Twitch viewing motivation	Survey (N = 1,097)	Social motivation predicts subscription behavior	Engagement without sponsorship outcomes
Speed and Thompson (2000)	Determinants of sponsorship response	Empirical study	Perceived fit and sincerity are key determinants	Origin of the Block 3 congruence construct
van Teijlingen and Hundley (2001)	Pilot study methodology	Methodological article	Defines the pilot as pre-testing of an instrument	Anchors the instrument-validation framing
van Teijlingen et al. (2001)	Conducting and reporting pilot studies	Peer-reviewed, worked example	Details of why pilots must be conducted and reported	Supports Chapter 3 and the framing of findings
Wohn et al. (2018)	PSR and viewers support behavior	Survey (N = 230)	PSR correlated with emotional, instrumental and financial support	Strongest PSR-to-behavior link; its limit motivates the gap
Wu et al. (2025)	Perceived fit and purchase behavior	Survey (N = 245), PLS-SEM	Fit, awareness and attitude jointly predict purchase behavior	Alternative causal structure to Noh et al. (2025)
Xu et al. (2022)	PSR and streamer credibility	Survey (N = 277), SEM	PSR and loyalty mediate credibility effect on brand attitude	Closes the PSR-to-sponsorship gap

8 METHOD

This chapter will explain how the research was designed and carried out: why primary data, how the instrument was built, the strategy behind it and the ethical decisions taken.

8.1 Data use justification

Almost all the literature reviewed above relies on secondary or published datasets, and none of those datasets measures the three constructs together. Xu et al. (2022) measure parasocial relationships and brand attitude but not congruence. Noh et al. (2025) and Wu et al. (2025) measure congruence and sponsorship outcomes but not parasocial relationships. Rogers et al. (2020) and Huettermann et al. (2020) manipulate or observe sponsor type without placing it next to either mechanism. There is no existing dataset that allows the joint examination this question needs.

Primary quantitative data were collected instead. The quantitative choice comes from the constructs themselves. Parasocial relationship strength, perceived congruence and perceived effectiveness are all measurable through validated attitudinal scales (Rubin et al., 1985; Speed & Thompson, 2000; Kim et al., 2015) and the question asks how they combine rather than how they are experienced. Since this is a pilot, the data test the instrument instead of answering the question, a distinction developed below.

8.2 Research tool and questions design justification

A self-completion online questionnaire was chosen. Self-completion removes interviewer effects and suits respondents spread across different places and online administration means recruiting through the communities where e-sports audiences already are (Saunders et al., 2019). The instrument was built in Google Forms.

Rather than write new measures, validated scaled were adapted, which is the preferable way whenever suitable instruments already exist (Saunders et al., 2019). The parasocial items come from the scale validated by Rubin et al. (1985) and adapted to streaming by Xu et al. (2022). Congruence items follow the perceived sponsor-event fit construct from Speed and Thompson (2000), operationalised in e-sports by Noh et al. (2025) and Wu et al. (2025). Effectiveness items reflect the cognitive and conative categories identified in the meta-analysis by Kim et al. (2015). All attitudinal items use a five-point Likert scale with a neutral midpoint and neutral wording.

Two design decisions are worth explaining. Respondents nominate a real sponsor they have in mind instead of reacting to a hypothetical one, because sponsorship effects are known to weaken under fictitious conditions (Kim et al., 2015). One negatively worded item was also placed in each attitudinal block as an attention check. Appendix C maps every item to its construct, its justifying literature and its objective.

8.3 Research strategy justification

Using the research onion (Saunders et al., 2019), the study is deductive, survey-based, mono-method quantitative and cross-sectional. Sampling is non-probability: convenience and snowball, recruited through Discord communities (LEC communities, Karmine Corp, Gentle mates, French Hardware...) and personal networks. That is a deliberate trade-off, accepted because a pilot tests procedures rather than generalises.

The framing of the pilot needs stressing, a pilot study is the pre-testing of an instrument, done to find out how the questions get interpreted, whether the data can support the intended analysis and whether the procedure works in practice (van Teijlingen & Hundley, 2001; van Teijlingen et al., 2001). With ten responses no relationship between variables can be tested, and none is claimed. What follow concerns item clarity, response variance, completion time and recruitment feasibility.

8.4 Ethical considerations

Consent was required before any item was shown and eligibility was limited to respondents aged eighteen or over which avoids the extra safeguarding requirement around minors. Data minimisation was applied throughout: no name, no email address, no age in years, no gender, no other identifying information and email collection was disabled in Google Forms. All responses are anonymous and cannot be traced back. The data collected is in a protected account (Google), are used only for this course, are shared with nobody and it will be deleted once the course grade is published which is consistent with GDPR limitation and retention (Saunders et al., 2019). The +18 eligibility depends on self-declaration responders and cannot be fact-checked in an anonymous online survey.

9 PLAN AND TIMELINE OF KEY RESEARCH MILESTONES

Figure 1 sets out the plan. The complete phase covers the instrument design and the pilot reported here. The projected phase covers the full-scale study that the pilot was meant to inform. The literature review runs across the whole thing instead of stopping after the review stage, since the findings must be read back against the literature at analysis and conclusion (Saunders et al., 2019). Milestones marked with a diamond are fixed course deadlines.

Figure 1: Research Gantt chart – completed phase (June to September 2026)

Nº	Activity	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep
1	Define research topic and scope	X			
2	Critical literature review	X	X	X	X
3	Source verification and reference management	X	X	X	
4	Refine research question, aim and objectives	X	X		
5	Assignment 2 submission - 7 July		X		
6	Read methodology literature		X	X	
7	Design questionnaire and justification table			X	
8	Ethical review and consent design			X	
9	Pilot data collection (n = 10)			X	
10	Data cleansing and descriptive analysis			X	
11	Discussion and conclusions			X	
12	Final review, word count and formatting			X	
13	Assignment 3 submission - 1 September				X

Figure 2: Research Gantt chart – projected phase (full-scale study)

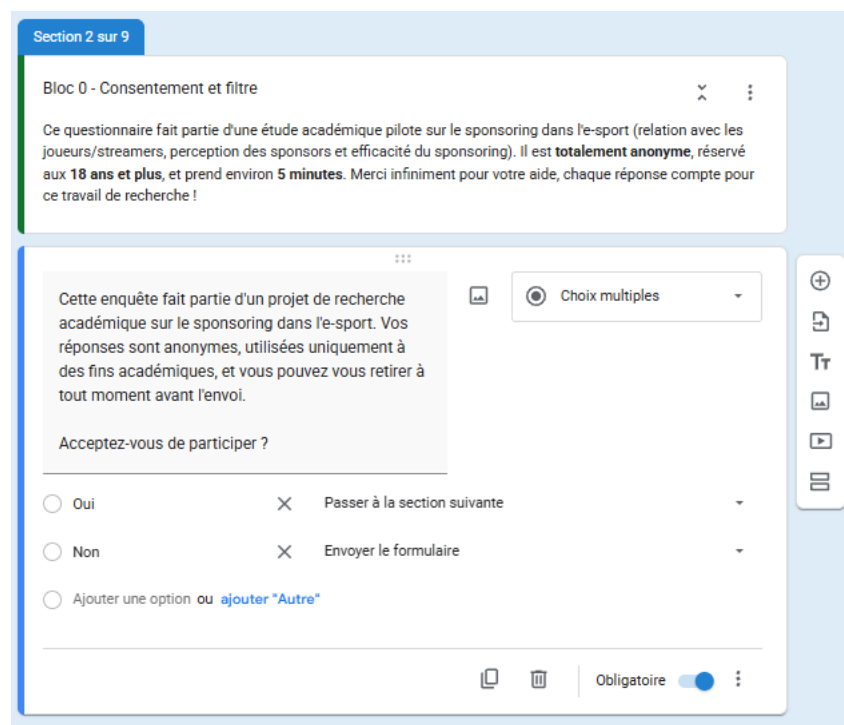
N°	Activity	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
14	Revise instrument following pilot findings	X			
15	Recode sponsor type as researcher-assigned variable	X			
16	Replace effectiveness items with validated scale	X			
17	Second pilot to confirm revisions		X		
18	Update literature review		X		X
19	Full-scale data collection with quota sampling		X	X	
20	Inferential analysis and moderation testing			X	X
21	Write-up and dissemination				X

10 DATA ANALYSIS AND DISCUSSION

Ten responses were collected between the 15th of August to the 18th of August 2026. This chapter follow data reduction, visualisation and conclusion drawing and verification and reports on the four things the pilot was designed to test.

10.1 Sample and data cleansing

One respondent was routed out at the relevance screening item which at least confirmed that the conditional branching worked and that left nine usable responses. Three cleansing steps followed. Sponsor names were normalised, since one brand had been entered in three different spellings and one respondent wrote a full sentence instead of a name. Free-text completion times were converted to numbers. Responses were checked for straight-lining and none showed uniform answering across all items.



The screenshot displays a survey interface for 'Section 2 sur 9'. The main heading is 'Bloc 0 - Consentement et filtre'. Below this, a paragraph explains that the questionnaire is part of a pilot academic study on e-sports sponsorship, is anonymous, reserved for those 18 and over, and takes about 5 minutes. It asks for participation and provides three options: 'Oui' (Yes), 'Non' (No), and 'Ajouter une option ou ajouter "Autre"'. Each option has a corresponding action: 'Passer à la section suivante' (Go to the next section), 'Envoyer le formulaire' (Send the form), and a link to 'ajouter "Autre"'. A 'Choix multiples' (Multiple choice) dropdown is visible on the right. At the bottom right, there is a toggle for 'Obligatoire' (Mandatory) which is currently turned on.

Figure 1 - First conditional branching

Section 3 sur 9

Bloc 0 - Consentement et filtre

Description (facultative)

Avez-vous 18 ans ou plus ?

☐ Oui
 ☒ Non

Passer à la section suivante
 Envoyer le formulaire

☐ Ajouter une option ou [ajouter "Autre"](#)

Choix multiples

Obligatoire

Figure 2 - Second conditional branching

Section 4 sur 9

Bloc 0 - Consentement et filtre

Description (facultative)

Suivez-vous des compétitions e-sport ou des streamers (ex : League of Legends, Valorant, CS2, streamers Twitch), même occasionnellement ?

☐ Oui
 ☒ Non

Passer à la section suivante
 Envoyer le formulaire

☐ Ajouter une option ou [ajouter "Autre"](#)

Choix multiples

Obligatoire

Figure 3 - Third conditional branching

10.2 Item clarity and instrument validity

The most consequential finding concerns the moderating variable. Two respondents named the same sponsor, a telecommunications operator, and put it in opposite categories, one endemic and one non-endemic. That brand falls outside gaming and technology by the definition given in the question itself so at least one of the answers is wrong. Self-assignment of sponsor type is therefore not a reliable measurement and the categorical moderator that sits at the centre of the research question cannot be captured in this way.

The two negatively worded attention checks failed as well. After reverse-coding, the gap between each item and the mean of the three positively worded items in its block reached 2.67 points on a five-point scale. One respondent had already flagged the parasocial item as confusing and pointed out that it was the only negatively phrased item on its page. When quality check diverges like this, the advice is to reconsider the item rather than the respondent (Saunders et al., 2019).

10.3 Response variance

Table 2 reports the item-level descriptives. The parasocial and congruence blocks disperse well enough, with standard deviations between 1.00 and 1.54 and responses spread across the scale. The effectiveness block does not behave the same way, since five to six of nine respondents picked the lowest point on each of its three items, which is a clear floor effect. The purchase-consideration item is also bimodal with responses at both ends and nothing at the middle.

10.4 Completion time and recruitment feasibility

Reported completion times ran from three to five minutes, with an average and median of four which matches the five minutes announced at recruitment. Seven responses came in within about three and half hours through Discord communities and personal networks, so online recruitment of this population is workable. The distribution is the weaker part, five of nine respondents named the same beverage brand and six of nine classified their sponsor as non-endemic against three as endemic, which leave the moderating badly unbalanced.

10.5 Discussion

These results speak to the instrument, not to the research question. The floor effect on perceived effectiveness sits awkwardly next to Huettermann et al. (2020) who found non-endemic sponsors perfectly capable of generating favourable attitudes and purchase intentions. Whether that is a real difference or just a measure that lacks sensitivity cannot be settled at this sample size (n=10). The classification failure is the more useful finding, and it qualifies how the endemic distinction by Rogers et al. (2020) and Gawrysiak et al. (2020) can be operationalised in audience surveys. A distinction that is clean on the researcher's side is not necessarily applied consistently by the people answering.

Table 2: Item-level descriptive statistics (n=9)

Item	Construct	Mean	SD	Min	Max	Distribution (1–5)
Q2.1	PSR - personal connection	2.56	1.33	1	4	3, 1, 2, 3, 0
Q2.2	PSR - perceived intimacy	2.22	1.20	1	4	3, 3, 1, 2, 0
Q2.3	PSR - anticipation	3.11	1.54	1	5	2, 1, 2, 2, 2
Q2.4	PSR - reverse-coded	2.67	1.32	1	5	2, 2, 3, 1, 1
Q3.1	Congruence - image fit	3.33	1.00	2	5	0, 2, 3, 3, 1
Q3.2	Congruence - logical fit	3.44	1.13	2	5	0, 2, 3, 2, 2
Q3.3	Congruence - shared values	3.22	1.20	1	5	1, 1, 3, 3, 1
Q3.4	Congruence - reverse-coded	2.33	1.50	1	5	4, 1, 2, 1, 1
Q4.1	Effectiveness - attitude	1.89	1.27	1	4	5, 2, 0, 2, 0
Q4.2	Effectiveness - purchase consideration	2.22	1.86	1	5	6, 0, 0, 1, 2
Q4.3	Effectiveness - awareness	1.56	1.01	1	4	6, 2, 0, 1, 0

Source: Google Sheets Form Responses

Table 3: Reverse-coded item consistency check (n=9)

Respondent	PSR positive items (mean)	Q2.4 reverse-coded	Gap	Congruence positive (mean)	Q3.4 reverse-coded	Gap
1	3.67	4	0.33	5.00	5	0.00
2	1.00	2	1.00	2.33	4	1.67
3	3.00	1	2.00	3.67	5	1.33
4	1.67	3	1.33	3.00	5	2.00
5	1.33	4	2.67	3.33	3	0.33
6	4.33	3	1.33	3.00	2	1.00
7	2.33	5	2.67	4.33	5	0.67
8	2.67	5	2.33	3.33	1	2.33
9	3.67	3	0.67	2.00	3	1.00

Source: Google Sheets Form Responses – Reverse-coded items recoded as 6-x.

Table 4: Sponsor nomination and self-assigned type (n=9)

Sponsor named (after cleansing)	Frequency	Self-assigned type
Red Bull	5	Non-endemic (5)
Orange	2	Non-endemic (1), Endemic (1)
Razer	1	Endemic (1)
Logitech	1	Endemic (1)

Source: Google Sheets Form Responses

11 CONCLUSIONS

11.1 Preliminary answers to the research question

The pilot does not answer the research question and was never meant to. With nine responses (one was moderated by Q.03), no relationship between parasocial relationships, congruence and perceived effectiveness can be tested and no moderating effect of sponsor type can be assessed. What it gave us is still necessary, the instrument measures parasocial relationships and congruence with adequate dispersion, takes about four minutes and can reach this population in few hours.

11.2 Limitations of this work

The sample is too small, self-selected and drawn by convenience from communities the researcher could reach so it is not representative of e-sports audiences. Age eligibility rests on self-declaration, it is a problem because that cannot be verified. No demographic data were collected so the sample cannot be described beyond viewing habits. The consent text shown to respondents covered purpose, and anonymity but left out the researcher's contact details and the retention period excepted under GDPR.

11.3 Recommendations for future research

Sponsor type should be coded by the researcher from the brand name given rather than assigned by the respondent. Both negatively items need rewording or removal. The effectiveness block needs revision and the validated scale published by Jo et al. (2026) is a stronger option than adapted items. A full-scale study should also use quotas to balance endemic and non-endemic nominations.

11.4 Recommendations for practice

For organisations and sponsors, the practical point is smaller than the research question but not trivial. Audiences do not carry the endemic and non-endemic distinction around the way the industry does. Category fit as a planning concept and category fit as something a viewer perceives are not the same thing, and inventory priced on the first may not deliver on the second.

12 REFERENCES

- Calapez, A., Ribeiro, T., Almeida, V., & Pedragosa, V. (2024). Esports fan identity toward sponsor–sponsee relationship: An understanding of the role-based identity. *International Journal of Sports Marketing and Sponsorship*, 25(1), 42–66. <https://doi.org/10.1108/IJSMS-02-2023-0030>
- Freitas, B. D. A., Contreras-Espinosa, R. S., & Correia, P. Á. P. (2020). Identifying the pros, cons and tactics of eSports sponsorships: An integrative literature review. *Comunicação Pública*, 15(28). <https://doi.org/10.4000/cp.7243>
- Funk, D. C., Pizzo, A. D., & Baker, B. J. (2018). eSport management: Embracing eSport education and research opportunities. *Sport Management Review*, 21(1), 7–13. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.smr.2017.07.008>
- Gawrysiak, J., Burton, R., Jenny, S., & Williams, D. (2020). Using esports efficiently to enhance and extend brand perceptions – A literature review. *Physical Culture and Sport. Studies and Research*, 86, 1–14. <https://doi.org/10.2478/pcssr-2020-0008>
- Giles, D. C. (2002). Parasocial interaction: A review of the literature and a model for future research. *Media Psychology*, 4(3), 279–305. https://doi.org/10.1207/S1532785XMEP0403_04
- Gwinner, K. (1997). A model of image creation and image transfer in event sponsorship. *International Marketing Review*, 14(3), 145–158. <https://doi.org/10.1108/02651339710170221>
- Hilvert-Bruce, Z., Neill, J. T., Sjöblom, M., & Hamari, J. (2018). Social motivations of live-streaming viewer engagement on Twitch. *Computers in Human Behavior*, 84, 58–67. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chb.2018.02.013>
- Horton, D., & Wohl, R. R. (1956). Mass communication and para-social interaction: Observations on intimacy at a distance. *Psychiatry*, 19(3), 215–229. <https://doi.org/10.1080/00332747.1956.11023049>
- Huettermann, M., Trail, G. T., Pizzo, A. D., & Stallone, V. (2020). Esports sponsorship: An empirical examination of esports consumers' perceptions of non-endemic sponsors.

- Journal of Global Sport Management*, 8(2), 524–549.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/24704067.2020.1846906>
- Jo, M., Pyun, D. Y., & Piggin, J. (2026). Development and validation of a scale for consumer beliefs about esports sponsorship. *International Journal of Sports Marketing and Sponsorship*, 27(4), 862–883. <https://doi.org/10.1108/IJSMS-08-2025-0403>
- Kim, Y., Lee, H.-W., Magnusen, M. J., & Kim, M. (2015). Factors influencing sponsorship effectiveness: A meta-analytic review and research synthesis. *Journal of Sport Management*, 29(4), 408–425. <https://doi.org/10.1123/jsm.2014-0056>
- Liu, Q., & Liu, B. (2025). The impact of sports event-brand fit on consumer brand responses: A meta-analytic review. *Frontiers in Sports and Active Living*, 7, Article 1598708. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fspor.2025.1598708>
- Noh, Y., Ryu, Y., & Kim, K. (2025). eSport consumption and sponsor brand equity: The mediating role of congruence. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 16, Article 1594068. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2025.1594068>
- Polyakova, O., Karagiorgos, T., Anagnostopoulos, C., & Alexandris, K. (2024). Testing the relationships among involvement, sponsorship perceived fit and intention to purchase sponsors' products: The case of esports tournament viewers. *International Journal of Sports Marketing and Sponsorship*, 25(5), 1000–1017. <https://doi.org/10.1108/IJSMS-12-2023-0246>
- Rogers, R., Farquhar, L., & Mummert, J. (2020). Audience response to endemic and non-endemic sponsors of esports events. *International Journal of Sports Marketing and Sponsorship*, 21(3), 561–576. <https://doi.org/10.1108/IJSMS-09-2019-0107>
- Rubin, A. M., Perse, E. M., & Powell, R. A. (1985). Loneliness, parasocial interaction, and local television news viewing. *Human Communication Research*, 12(2), 155–180. <https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1468-2958.1985.tb00071.x>
- Saunders, M. N. K., Lewis, P., & Thornhill, A. (2019). *Research methods for business students* (8th ed.). Harlow: Pearson Education. <https://lccn.loc.gov/2018058370>

- Sherrick, B., Smith, C., Jia, Y., Thomas, B., & Franklin, S. (2023). How parasocial phenomena contribute to sense of community on Twitch. *Journal of Broadcasting & Electronic Media*, 67(1), 47–67. <https://doi.org/10.1080/08838151.2022.2151599>
- Silva, L. R. da, & Almeida, V. M. C. de. (2024). eSports' event sponsorship: Sponsor's brand authenticity, brand equity and purchase intention. *Brazilian Administration Review*, 21(Supplement), e240138. <https://doi.org/10.1590/1807-7692bar2024240138>
- Sjöblom, M., & Hamari, J. (2017). Why do people watch others play video games? An empirical study on the motivations of Twitch users. *Computers in Human Behavior*, 75, 985–996. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.chb.2016.10.019>
- Speed, R., & Thompson, P. (2000). Determinants of sports sponsorship response. *Journal of the Academy of Marketing Science*, 28(2), 226–238. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0092070300282004>
- van Teijlingen, E. R., & Hundley, V. (2001). The importance of pilot studies. *Social Research Update*, (35). Guildford: University of Surrey. <https://sru.soc.surrey.ac.uk/SRU35.html>
- van Teijlingen, E. R., Rennie, A.-M., Hundley, V., & Graham, W. (2001). The importance of conducting and reporting pilot studies: The example of the Scottish Births Survey. *Journal of Advanced Nursing*, 34(3), 289–295. <https://doi.org/10.1046/j.1365-2648.2001.01757.x>
- Wohn, D. Y., Freeman, G., & McLaughlin, C. (2018). Explaining viewers' emotional, instrumental, and financial support provision for live streamers. In *Proceedings of the 2018 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems* (pp. 1–13). Association for Computing Machinery. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3173574.3174048>
- Wu, Y.-F., Wu, Y.-T., & Chen, B.-C. (2025). The influence of sponsorship effectiveness on consumer perceptions and purchasing behavior in esports. *International Journal of Sports Marketing and Sponsorship*, 26(5), 950–968. <https://doi.org/10.1108/IJSMS-10-2024-0282>
- Xu, Q., Kim, H., & Billings, A. C. (2022). Let's watch live streaming: How streamer credibility influences brand attitude in esports streamer marketing. *Communication & Sport*, 10(2), 271–290. <https://doi.org/10.1177/21674795211067819>

13 APPENDIX A: FULL TRANSCRIPTION OF THE GOOGLE FORMS (FR/EN)

Administered in French. Original French wording is quoted in guillemets (« »), followed by an English rendering. The form used 5-point Likert scales (1 = strongly disagree / pas du tout d'accord; 5 = strongly agree / tout à fait d'accord). Conditional branching (skip logic) routed any respondent who answered negatively at Q0.1, Q0.2 or Q0.3 directly to the end of the form, with no further data recorded.

Google form link: <https://forms.gle/Qa4qXbcK8w1yB7Gu7>

13.1 Form title:

« Sponsoring E-sport - Questionnaire pilote »

Sponsorship in E-sports - Pilot Questionnaire

13.2 Form description:

« Ce questionnaire fait partie d'une étude académique pilote sur le sponsoring dans l'e-sport (relation avec les joueurs/streamers, perception des sponsors et efficacité du sponsoring). Il est totalement anonyme, réservé aux 18 ans et plus, et prend environ 5 minutes. Merci infiniment pour votre aide, chaque réponse compte pour ce travail de recherche ! »

This questionnaire is part of an academic pilot study on e-sports sponsorship (relationship with players/streamers, sponsor perception, and sponsorship effectiveness). It is completely anonymous, restricted to respondents aged 18 and over, and takes about 5 minutes. Thank you so much for your help - every response matters for this research.

13.3 Block 0 - Consent and screening

Three compulsory items, each on its own Google Forms section to allow individual skip logic. Any negative answer routes the respondent to the end of the form ('Passer à la section suivante' otherwise).

Q0.1 (compulsory, exits on 'Non') « Cette enquête fait partie d'un projet de recherche académique sur le sponsoring dans l'e-sport. Vos réponses sont anonymes, utilisées uniquement à des fins académiques, et vous pouvez vous retirer à tout moment avant l'envoi. Acceptez-vous de participer ? »

This survey is part of an academic research project on sponsorship in e-sports. Your answers are anonymous, used only for academic purposes, and you may withdraw at any time before submission. Do you agree to take part? [Oui / Non - Yes / No]

Q0.2 (compulsory, exits on 'Non') « Avez-vous 18 ans ou plus ? »

Are you 18 years of age or older? [Oui / Non - Yes / No]

Q0.3 (compulsory, exits on 'Non') « Suivez-vous des compétitions e-sport ou des streamers (ex : League of Legends, Valorant, CS2, streamers Twitch), même occasionnellement ? »

Do you follow e-sports competitions or streamers (e.g. League of Legends, Valorant, CS2, Twitch streamers), even occasionally? [Oui / Non - Yes / No]

13.4 Block 1 - Reference sponsor

Q1.1 (short answer, compulsory) « Quel(s) jeu(x) e-sport ou quel(s) streamer(s) suivez-vous le plus ? »

Which e-sports title(s) or streamer(s) do you follow the most?

Q1.2 (short answer, compulsory) « Pensez à UN sponsor que vous avez vu associé à une équipe, un événement ou un streamer e-sport que vous suivez. Nommez-le. »

Think of ONE sponsor you have seen associated with a team, event, or e-sports streamer you follow. Name it.

Q1.3 (multiple choice with embedded definition, compulsory) « Un sponsor endémique est une marque dont l'activité principale appartient directement au secteur du jeu vidéo ou de la tech gaming (ex : matériel informatique, périphériques gaming, logiciels - comme Razer, Logitech, Intel). Un sponsor non-endémique vient d'un autre secteur qui cherche simplement à toucher l'audience e-sport (ex : boissons, alimentation, automobile, banque, comme Kit Kat, Michelin en LEC). Le sponsor que vous avez cité en Q1.2 est-il, selon vous : Un sponsor endémique (secteur gaming/tech) / Un sponsor non-endémique (autre secteur) / Je ne suis pas sûr(e) »

An endemic sponsor is a brand whose core business belongs directly to the video game or gaming tech sector (e.g. computer hardware, gaming peripherals, software - such as Razer, Logitech, Intel). A non-endemic sponsor comes from another sector simply seeking exposure to the e-sports audience (e.g. drinks, food, automotive, banking - such as Kit Kat, Michelin in the LEC). Is the sponsor you named in Q1.2, in your view: An endemic sponsor (gaming/tech sector) / A non-endemic sponsor (other sector) / Not sure

13.5 Block 2 - Parasocial relationship (PSR)

5-point Likert scale: 1 = Pas du tout d'accord / Strongly disagree - 5 = Tout à fait d'accord / Strongly agree. All items compulsory.

Q2.1 « Je ressens une connexion personnelle avec les joueurs/streamers que je suis dans cet e-sport. »

I feel a personal connection with the players/streamers I follow in this e-sport.

Q2.2 « J'ai l'impression de connaître ces joueurs/streamers, même si nous ne nous sommes jamais rencontrés. »

I feel like I know these players/streamers, even though we have never met.

Q2.3 « J'attends avec impatience de regarder ou suivre le contenu de ce joueur/streamer. »

I look forward to watching or following this player's/streamer's content.

Q2.4 (reverse-coded) « Je ne me sens pas investi(e) émotionnellement dans les joueurs/streamers que je suis. »

I do not feel emotionally invested in the players/streamers I follow.

Q2.5 (short answer, compulsory, consistency check) « Pour rappel, quel sponsor avez-vous nommé à la question précédente concernant le sponsor ? »

As a reminder, which sponsor did you name in the earlier question about the sponsor?

13.6 Block 3 - Perceived sponsor-sponsee congruence

« Pour les questions suivantes, pensez au SPONSOR que vous avez identifié plus haut (celui que vous avez nommé, endémique ou non-endémique). »

For the following questions, think about the SPONSOR you identified earlier (the one you named, whether endemic or non-endemic).

5-point Likert scale, all items compulsory.

Q3.1 « Ce sponsor correspond bien à l'image de l'équipe/l'événement/le streamer qu'il soutient. »

This sponsor fits well with the image of the team/event/streamer it supports.

Q3.2 « Il me paraît logique que ce sponsor en particulier soutienne cette équipe/cet événement/ce streamer. »

It makes sense to me that this particular sponsor supports this team/event/streamer.

Q3.3 « Ce sponsor et la scène e-sport partagent des valeurs similaires. »

This sponsor and the e-sports scene share similar values.

Q3.4 (reverse-coded) « Ce sponsor semble déplacé dans la scène e-sport. »

This sponsor seems out of place in the e-sports scene.

13.7 Block 4 - Perceived sponsorship effectiveness

Same reminder as Block 3 displayed at the top of the section. 5-point Likert scale, all items compulsory.

Q4.1 « Grâce à ce sponsoring, j'ai une image plus positive de ce sponsor. »

Because of this sponsorship, I have a more positive image of this sponsor.

Q4.2 « Je serais plus enclin(e) à considérer les produits/services de ce sponsor grâce à ce sponsoring. »

I would be more inclined to consider this sponsor's products/services because of this sponsorship.

Q4.3 « Ce sponsoring a augmenté ma connaissance de la marque du sponsor. »

This sponsorship increased my awareness of the sponsor's brand.

13.8 Block 5 - Instrument feedback

Optional, free-text. Not analysed for the research question - used solely to assess the pilot instrument itself.

Q5.1 (short answer, optional) « Une question vous a-t-elle semblé peu claire ou difficile à comprendre ? Si oui, laquelle et pourquoi ? »

Did any question seem unclear or difficult to understand? If so, which one and why?

Q5.2 (short answer, optional) « Combien de temps environ avez-vous mis pour répondre à ce questionnaire ? »

Approximately how long did it take you to complete this questionnaire?

Q5.3 (short answer, optional) « Avez-vous d'autres commentaires sur ce questionnaire ? »

Do you have any other comments about this questionnaire?

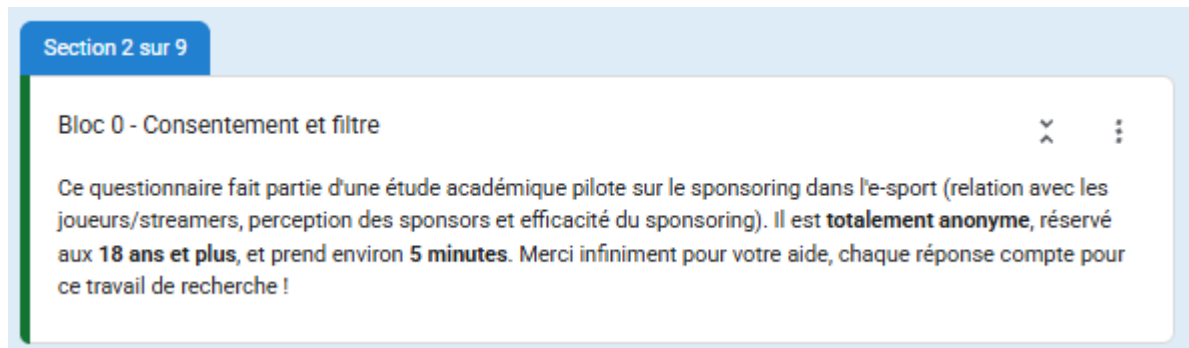
13.9 End-of-form confirmation message

« Merci beaucoup d'avoir pris le temps ! »

Thank you so much for taking the time!

14 APPENDIX B: CONSENT DOCUMENTATION

14.1 Consent as presented to pilot respondents



Section 2 sur 9

Bloc 0 - Consentement et filtre

Ce questionnaire fait partie d'une étude académique pilote sur le sponsoring dans l'e-sport (relation avec les joueurs/streamers, perception des sponsors et efficacité du sponsoring). Il est **totale**ment anonyme, réservé aux **18 ans et plus**, et prend environ **5 minutes**. Merci infiniment pour votre aide, chaque réponse compte pour ce travail de recherche !

Figure 4 - Form description

14.2 Recruitment message

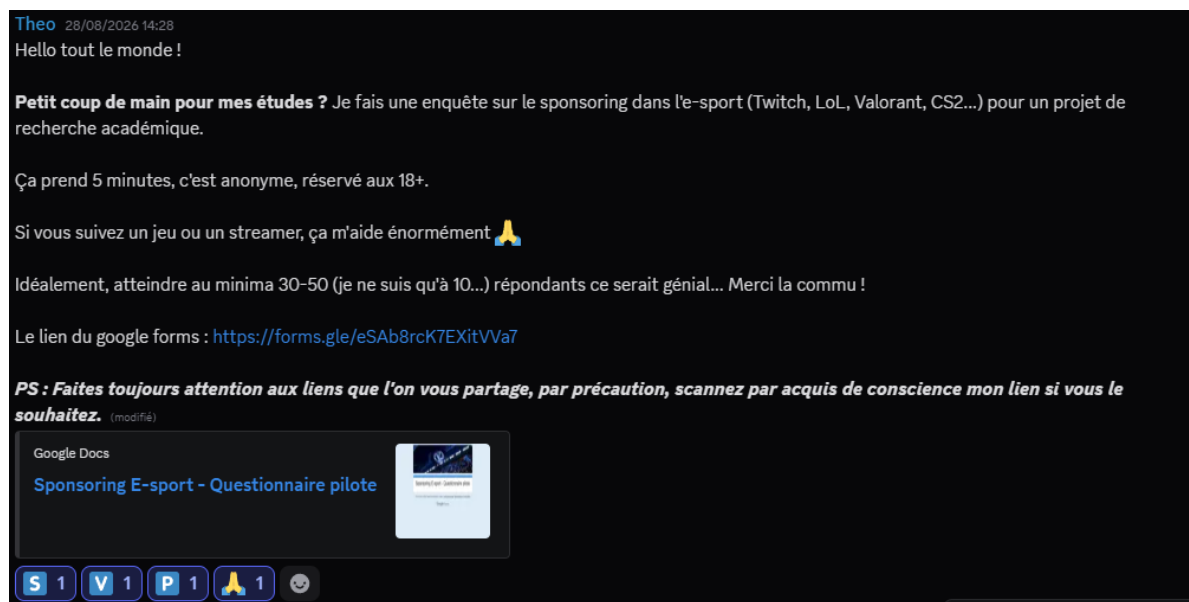


Figure 5 - Recruitment message circulated on Disccord communities

15 APPENDIX C: DATA COLLECTION QUESTIONS

JUSTIFICATION TABLE

Who (all items): self-selected e-sports viewers aged eighteen or over who follow e-sports competitions or streamers at least occasionally. Non-probability convenience and snowball sample recruited through Discord communities and personal networks (Saunders et al., 2019).

How (all items): self-completed online questionnaire administered via Google Forms with conditional branching; estimated completion time five minutes.

Item	Question type	Construct	Justification and literature link	Objective
Q0.1	Dichotomous, compulsory	Informed consent	Required before any personal data processing; establishes voluntary participation and right to withdraw (Saunders et al., 2019).	O1
Q0.2	Dichotomous, exits	Age eligibility	Restricts the sample to adults, avoiding safeguarding requirements attached to minors (Saunders et al., 2019).	O1
Q0.3	Dichotomous, exits	Relevance screening	Without exposure to e-sports content, no parasocial relationship or sponsor perception can meaningfully be reported (Sjöblom & Hamari, 2017).	O1, O3
Q1.1	Open, short	Viewing context	Allows the sample to be described and concentration in a single title identified; viewer motivations differ across content types (Hilvert-Bruce et al., 2018).	O3
Q1.2	Open, short	Sponsor identification	Anchors subsequent items to a concrete, respondent-chosen sponsor; sponsorship effects shrink under fictitious stimuli (Kim et al., 2015).	O1
Q1.3	Multiple choice with definition	Sponsor type (moderator)	Operationalises the endemic distinction. Rogers et al. (2020) find endemic sponsors favoured; Huettermann et al. (2020) find non-endemic sponsors can benefit. The definition is embedded because the term is technical.	O1, O3
Q2.1	5-point Likert	PSR - personal connection	Core dimension of the scale validated by Rubin et al. (1985), adapted to streaming by Xu et al. (2022).	O1, O2
Q2.2	5-point Likert	PSR - perceived intimacy	Reflects the founding definition of parasocial interaction as intimacy at a distance (Horton & Wohl, 1956).	O1, O2
Q2.3	5-point Likert	PSR - anticipation	Captures affinity, a salient predictor of parasocial interaction (Rubin et al., 1985); PSR correlates with support behaviour (Wohn et al., 2018).	O1, O2
Q2.4	5-point Likert, reverse	PSR - emotional investment	Attention and acquiescence check, standard when re-using scales (Saunders et al., 2019).	O2
Q2.5	Open, short	Sponsor recall	Re-anchors the respondent before the congruence block and allows detection of inconsistent	O2

Item	Question type	Construct	Justification and literature link	Objective
			responding; Google Forms cannot pipe earlier answers into later question text.	
Q3.1	5-point Likert	Congruence - image fit	Perceived fit is a principal determinant of sponsorship response (Speed & Thompson, 2000), operating through image transfer (Gwinner, 1997).	O1, O2
Q3.2	5-point Likert	Congruence - logical fit	Distinguishes functional from image congruence, which operate differently by context.	O1, O2
Q3.3	5-point Likert	Congruence - shared values	Congruence mediates consumption and sponsor brand equity (Noh et al., 2025); shared values are a component of perceived fit.	O1, O2
Q3.4	5-point Likert, reverse	Congruence - incongruence	Attention check mirroring Q2.4; also captures perceived incongruence, theoretically distinct from low congruence.	O2
Q4.1	5-point Likert	Effectiveness - affective	Attitude toward the sponsor is a consumer-focused outcome category (Kim et al., 2015).	O1, O2
Q4.2	5-point Likert	Effectiveness - conative	Perceived fit predicts purchase intention among e-sports viewers (Polyakova et al., 2024); Wu et al. (2025) extend this to behaviour.	O1, O2
Q4.3	5-point Likert	Effectiveness - cognitive	Awareness is the cognitive outcome dimension (Kim et al., 2015) and a component of sponsor brand equity (Noh et al., 2025).	O1, O2
Q5.1	Open, optional	Instrument clarity	Addresses the pilot's primary purpose: testing how questions are interpreted before a large-scale survey (van Teijlingen & Hundley, 2001).	O2
Q5.2	Open, optional	Completion time	Allows the advertised estimate to be compared against reported actual time.	O2, O3
Q5.3	Open, optional	General feedback	Captures problems closed items cannot surface.	O2

16 APPENDIX D: ANONYMISED PILOT RESPONSE DATA

R	Sponsor	Type	Q2.1	Q2.2	Q2.3	Q2.4	Q3.1	Q3.2	Q3.3	Q3.4	Q4.1	Q4.2	Q4.3	Time (min)
1	Razer	Endemic	3	4	4	2	5	5	5	1	4	5	4	3
2	Red Bull	Non-endemic	1	1	1	4	3	3	1	2	1	1	1	5
3	Red Bull	Non-endemic	4	2	3	5	4	4	3	1	4	1	1	5
4	Orange	Non-endemic	2	2	1	3	3	2	4	1	1	1	2	5
5	Red Bull	Non-endemic	1	1	2	2	2	4	4	3	1	1	1	3
6	Red Bull	Non-endemic	4	4	5	3	3	3	3	4	2	1	1	5
7	Red Bull	Non-endemic	1	1	5	1	4	5	4	1	1	5	1	4
8	Logitech	Endemic	3	2	3	1	4	3	3	5	2	4	2	3
9	Orange	Endemic	4	3	4	3	2	2	2	3	1	1	1	3

Source: Google Sheets Form Responses

17 APPENDIX E: AI PROMPTS (RESEARCH & ANALYSIS ASSISTANCE, TABLE FORMATTING & APA CITATION FORMATTING)

“En te basant sur mon premier devoir ci-joint, pourrais-tu m'aider à concevoir un questionnaire (Google Forms).

Le questionnaire doit notamment répondre aux questions de relation parasociale, de congruence et d'efficacité perçue.

Ce questionnaire ne sera envoyé qu'à petite échelle et j'aurai certainement peu de répondants, il est donc préférable de seulement réaliser un pilot. Agis donc en conséquence.”

Ta question de recherche porte sur trois mécanismes — la relation parasociale, la congruence perçue sponsor-sponsee, et l'efficacité du sponsoring — avec le statut endémique/non-endémique du sponsor comme variable modératrice. Je construis le questionnaire autour de ça, en m'appuyant sur des échelles déjà validées dans la littérature plutôt qu'en inventant des items.

Quelques choix de conception, avant le questionnaire lui-même :

- **Échelle de Likert 5 points**, avec option neutre.
- Un **item inversé** par bloc construit (PSR, congruence), pour repérer les réponses données sans attention.
- Une question de **filtre 18+**, pour des raisons de consentement RGPD — un mineur ne peut pas valablement consentir seul à la collecte de ses données.
- Le répondant **nomme lui-même un sponsor réel** qu'il connaît, plutôt que de réagir à un exemple imposé — les effets de sponsoring s'affaiblissent avec des stimuli fictifs.
- Une définition d'« endémique » **intégrée dans la question**, parce que le terme est technique et pas familier à tout le monde.

Presented file

Voilà le questionnaire complet, prêt à transposer sur Google Forms. Trois points de conception à valider avant de le mettre en ligne :

L'échelle 5 points avec option neutre — dis-moi si tu préfères forcer une position (4 ou 6 points sans neutre).

Les items inversés (Q2.4, Q3.4) — utiles pour repérer les réponses données sans lecture attentive, mais avec peu de répondants ils serviront surtout à commenter la qualité des réponses plutôt qu'à exclure des données.

Aucune question démographique — choix pour rester léger côté RGPD et rapide à remplir. Dis-moi si tu en veux (utile pour décrire l'échantillon).

Une fois en ligne, je peux t'accompagner pas à pas sur la configuration Google Forms (types de question, logique de saut sur le Bloc 0) si besoin.

“En te basant sur les 26 différentes sources que je te joins, peux-tu me générer fichier à importer dans Mendeley afin qu'il me génère une "references list" au format APA 6th edition à insérer à la fin de mon devoir:

- Calapez et al. (2024)
- Freitas et al. (2020)
- Funk et al. (2018)
- Gawrysiak et al. (2020)
- Giles (2002)
- Gwinner (1997)
- Hilvert-Bruce et al. (2018)
- Horton and Wohl (1956)
- Huettermann et al. (2020)
- Jo et al. (2026)
- Kim et al. (2015)
- Liu and Liu (2025)
- Noh et al. (2025)
- Polyakova et al. (2024)
- Rogers et al. (2020)
- Rubin et al. (1985)
- Saunders et al. (2019)
- Sherrick et al. (2023)
- Silva and Almeida (2024)
- Sjöblom and Hamari (2017)
- Speed and Thompson (2000)
- van Teijlingen and Hundley (2001)
- van Teijlingen et al. (2001)
- Wohn et al. (2018)
- Wu et al. (2025)
- Xu et al. (2022)”

Fichier créé, a exécuté une commande, lu un fichier

26 entrées, format RIS — c'est le format universel que Mendeley (et Zotero, EndNote) importent directement.

Comment l'importer

Dans Mendeley Desktop : **File → Import → RIS (*.ris)**, sélectionne le fichier. Les 26 références apparaissent dans ta bibliothèque.

Pour générer la liste APA en fin de document : **References → Citation Style → More Styles**, cherche « APA 6th edition » dans la liste (elle est intégrée par défaut dans Mendeley, pas besoin de la télécharger séparément). Ensuite **Insert Bibliography** te génère la liste complète, triée alphabétiquement, dans le format exact qu'on a construit à la main plus haut dans la conversation.

“Du fait de l'échec de formatage de Mendeley pour ma "reference list", peux-tu me générer un fichier word dans lequel tu me reprends les 26 sources cités précédemment en respectant ces consignes :

- APA formatted Name, year title, place of publication and DOI, URL etc. Alphabetically ordered, no bullet points or numbering”

Rendu propre — retrait en sablier (hanging indent), Times New Roman 12, interligne 1,5, alphabétique, pas de puce ni numéro.

Presented file

26 sources, sans dépendance à Mendeley. Toutes les valeurs (volume, numéro, pages, DOI) sont celles vérifiées une par une plus tôt dans la conversation — c'est exactement le contenu de `references_APA_A3.md`, mis en forme Word.

Deux choses à copier-coller directement dans ton rapport final : ouvre ce fichier, sélectionne tout sous le titre "References", colle dans ta section References à la place de ce qui s'y trouve déjà.

Un point que j'ai corrigé au passage : **Wohn et al. (2018)**, celle qui manquait dans ton export Mendeley, est bien présente ici — format article de conférence avec la mention "*In Proceedings of the 2018 CHI Conference...*", conforme APA pour ce type de source.

Un rappel avant de considérer que c'est terminé : c'est une liste statique, pas connectée à Mendeley. Si tu ajoutes ou retires une citation dans le corps du texte après coup, il faudra mettre à jour ce fichier à la main — aucune synchronisation automatique cette fois.



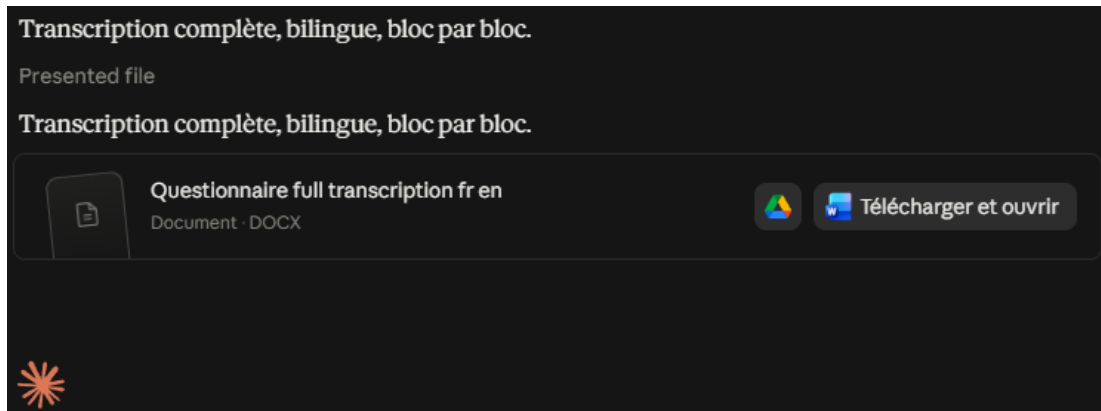
References apa6 a3
Document · DOCX



Télécharger et ouvrir

« Peux-tu me retranscrire à l'écrit l'entièreté de mon questionnaire Google Forms en distinguant bien les différents blocks et en y mettant la version anglaise pour mon devoir, car mon questionnaire est en français.

Voici les screens de mon Google Forms (<https://forms.gle/1wRNAokpZQH7TmcA>) ci-joint. »



“A partir du questionnaire que l'on a réalisé ensemble, pourrais-tu me faire un tableau récapitulant les différentes question, pourquoi elles sont là, le lien avec la littérature et le lien avec nos 3 objectifs.”

Fichier créé, a exécuté une commande, lu un fichier

Trois choses à noter sur ce tableau :

Certains items n'ont pas de référence de littérature propre, et c'est volontaire — pas un oubli. Q2.5 pallie une limite technique de Google Forms (impossible d'insérer automatiquement une réponse précédente dans le texte d'une question suivante). Q2.4, Q3.2, Q3.4, Q5.3 sont soit des contrôles qualité qui dérivent directement de l'item positif qu'ils accompagnent, soit des questions ouvertes qui n'ont pas besoin d'ancrage théorique.

Plusieurs items servent deux objectifs à la fois. Q1.3 est le cas le plus net : elle sert O1 (mesurer une variable) et O3 (informer la faisabilité de l'échantillonnage) — et si sa fiabilité se révèle mauvaise à l'analyse, elle informera aussi O2.

Ce tableau doit resservir plus tard. Au moment d'analyser les réponses, chaque item peut être réévalué contre sa justification ici posée : si une question censée être claire s'avère en réalité mal comprise par les répondants, ce n'est pas un aléa isolé — c'est un résultat de pilote qui mérite d'être documenté et discuté.



Tableau justification
Document · MD



Télécharger et ouvrir

18 APPENDIX F: SELF ASSESSMENT

18.1 Safe Assign – Learn KEDGE Business School

DISCLAIMER: The file used for the Compilatio tool scan is not the final version, why? When I uploaded the final version of the report, the content provided by the template (Title page, Statement of originality, APA references...) is flagged as similar content but that's normal. So, I isolated the main body of my report (Executive summary, Introduction, Literature review, Conclusion...) and the similarity score, AI is now 0%.

Assignment 3 - BRSM - Theo NOYON (test Compilatio & Safe Assign - uniquement texte)

The screenshot displays the Safe Assign report for 'Assignment 3 - BRSM - Theo NOYON'. On the left, a green checkmark indicates 'Risque faible' (Low risk), with a note stating that the text contains citations and phrases that correspond to other documents but are not plagiarized. Below this, a table shows 'Concordance de texte générale' with a 'Concordance moyenne' of 1% and a 'Concordance la plus élevée' of 1% for the assignment. On the right, a sidebar shows 'Autre contenu' with a 1% similarity score. The main text area displays a table of contents for the assignment, including sections like 'ABBREVIATIONS LIST', 'GLOSSARY', 'INTRODUCTION', 'EXECUTIVE SUMMARY', 'DATA ANALYSIS AND DISCUSSION', and 'CONCLUSIONS'.

18.2 Compilatio Tool

DISCLAIMER: The file used for the Compilatio tool scan is not the final version, why? When I uploaded the final version of the report, the content provided by the template (Title page, Statement of originality, APA references...) is flagged as similar content but that's normal. So, I isolated the main body of my report (Executive summary, Introduction, Literature review, Conclusion...) and the similarity score, AI is now 0%.

Assignment 3 - BRSM - Theo NOYON (test Compilatio & Safe Assign - uniquement texte)

The screenshot shows the Compilatio tool interface for the same assignment. It displays two sections: 'Similitudes' (Similarities) and 'Détection IA' (AI Detection). Both sections show a score of 0%. The 'Similitudes' section includes a note about passages that are similar to sources found in different collections and a button to 'Voir les sources'. The 'Détection IA' section includes a note about passages that are stylistically close to text generated by AI and a button to 'Interpréter le score de détection IA'.